

July 2013

MONDAY, JULY 8, 2013 AT 7:14 PM

I picked up Blades of Steel yesterday at the Valley Mall flea market. Today I got the chance to play it co-op with Aiden. Like I would do so many years years ago, he requested a tie game so that we reach a shoot-out. That alone was well worth the five dollars I paid.

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TUESDAY, JULY 23, 2013 AT 6:14 PM

So it goes.

Vonnegut's go-to phrase for a death in Slaughterhouse V. I'll try and write some more on this after I finish the book for the second time.

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 26° MOSTLY CLOUDY

WEDNESDAY, JULY 24, 2013 AT 12:23 PM



8 days to go until the due date. Woke up in a pleasant mood. It's funny that all it takes to be happy is to be happy. What a lark.

Ran 4.89k today in very humid conditions. I sweat for a good hour afterwards. There is an odd satisfaction in that. A lingering pat on the back.

In a Name

- Theodore
- Frank

Those are the top contenders in my mind right now. Theodore looks great on the page though it gets a few odd looks/silences/scoffs. Theo... Ted.... I don't know, that part is not really up to me. John was never my parents' plan (certainly not mom's)

A Method

Again I've had the grand idea that I should be writing more. Of course I should. I write maybe an average of about a medium length sentence per day. Perhaps that would be fine if it actually were a sentence I were constructing instead of grocery lists and other such jottings. Well lookie here. Look at me go.

I'm using the writing desk downstairs with the iPad + external keyboard. This really is the ideal setup for the technology at my disposal. I'm using Day One, a journalling app for the purposes of this entry. My first impressions of it are good. When you first open the app for the day you are greeted with a blank page to write on with the current time and weather already embedded out of the way on the bottom. Like other journalling apps it allows for embedding a picture. I really enjoy that feature and have only used it to success once, after running the entire trail on Joe Howe in Halifax! I should use it more often...

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 16° CLOUDY

THURSDAY, JULY 25, 2013 AT 1:58 AM



Late Night

So this will be my last night up late until the baby comes. Is that significant at all? Probably not. Is one allowed to question and answer oneself so obnoxiously? ...

As we get closer to 'the day', I'm visualizing what it will be like. I get a little stomach sick.

What is it about today in particular that made me able to write more? And, more importantly, to write moderately well. I hope to be someone who gets his ideas onto a page, modestly presented. I'm at my very happiest in my more expressive moments. It does me a

great deal of good and has the infinitesimal chance of doing someone else some good. Surely, given what I'm usually up to in my spare time, this is the winner. So that's what I'm going to do, goddamnit. I'll eventually settle into a style, a predictable manner of idea-sharing, and then I'll try something that takes guts. I don't know what that will be, but it will involve sweaty palms and compulsive email-checking.

Games

We were at Jared and Laura's tonight playing boardgames. Laura won Settlers and Rebecca won Munchkin. It was my first time playing Munchkin. It's a fun party game, but if your not really on the mood for such a game I can see how it would be incredibly boring. A bit long for the type of game it is but the humour and presentation gives it some charm.

Tomorrow

I hope that happy switch gets triggered again tomorrow morning when I wake up. I have to have the garbage out in roughly 6 hours. That won't help, but at least I've acknowledged it. Sometimes that's all you need to do. Deal with what must be done and push on.

CANADA • 20° CLOUDY

THURSDAY, JULY 25, 2013 AT 12:27 PM

Signs

I finished *Slaughterhouse V* for the second time yesterday (this time on the toilet). For the past couple of weeks I've been slowly going through Ian McEwan's *Saturday*. It's filled with great writing and characterization but so far the story is not gripping me. The back of the book promises a bit of a shake-up, so I'll continue on.

Anyways... now that Theodore is my baby-name of choice I see it popping up everywhere. This happened when we bought the Mazda 3 as well. I'm racking my brain for the word, if there is one, that describes this... hmm...

Anyways... anyways... anyways...

Theodore appears in both novels. Perowne, the main character in *Saturday*, has a son with the name - nicknamed Theo. Vonnegut meanwhile quotes two different Theodores - Theodore Roethke, the American poet, and Theodore Roosevelt, America's 26th President.

Also, I've had a real urge to pick up *The Brothers Karamozov* again,

written by a Theodore of the Russian-kind.

I may be overruled on the name, either by my own doing or the lady's, which is fine, but it's nice to think about what is in a name and what, if any, effect it could have on the child's life. The things we do when impatiently waiting (and when unemployed).

CANADA • 24° CLOUDY

SATURDAY, JULY 27, 2013 AT 5:02 PM

Weather

The Weather Network has been calling for thundershowers all day. Not a drop has fallen. I doubted the hanging of clothes but she wins again. Quite a day for it. Two loads!

4 sleeps until the due date. We are going on another kind of date tonight; very likely our last one before baby makes an appearance. I'm really tied to the name Theodore and with each passing day. We'll see!

CANADA • 25° MOSTLY CLOUDY

MONDAY, JULY 29, 2013 AT 10:13 AM

~ 3 Sleeps to go! (-2/+7)

The folks will be coming here on Friday, baby or no baby. They are going to spend the weekend at the Grenfell chalets for a few nights before heading to Ontario for Alyson's wedding.

Ran my longest distance yesterday - 16.01km! It was Tely 10 day in St. John's and when I learned a few months ago that I wouldn't be able to make it in to town to run it (baby....!) I was mildly disappointed. I hadn't planned to run that much yesterday but my ankle was feeling good, the weather was perfect, and my gatorade supply was sufficient. Sore knees today, but a day of rest outta sort me out.

I feel older now that we own a deep freeze (a very old and well used one from Rebecca's nan). We've had it for about 2 weeks now and it is almost filled up. That would be easy if we had just bought things and put them in there for later, but most of it is filled with food that we made! Bread, hamburger buns, hamburgers, chili, baked beans, spaghetti sauce, self-sliced fast fry pork chops, self-picked berries, and turkey soup! A great start for us freezer newbies.

Nerdy

Everquest Next news will be officially revealed this coming Friday, August 2nd. I didn't think I'd be excited but man o man... just like a teenager again. I lived *Everquest* for 3-4 years and have great memories of the early friendships made in game (I was a member of Brell's Legion on Druzzil Ro). When *Evequest 2* was announced I feel as I do now. It was exciting to play for the first couple of months, but I quickly lost interest. Perhaps I'll never play a game like I did the original again and that is probably for the best. Buying into the hype can sometimes be fun, so I'll continue doing so this time around.

CANADA • 11° MOSTLY CLOUDY

August 2013

THURSDAY, AUGUST 1, 2013 AT 10:02 AM

Today's the day

Ok, maybe not. As the app on Rebecca's phone mentioned, only 5% of people go on there due date (not exactly the stat we care most about).

Super hyped about the eqnext reveal tomorrow. This'll be the last hurrah of mmo hypes for me... at least for a nice long while.

Ok, going for a run now.

CANADA •

FRIDAY, AUGUST 2, 2013 AT 2:12 AM

Strengths

Play the guitar today. Any chance I get. Play old tabs, write songs. Share. Be myself. I am a bit of a sap at heart... deal with it. Find that old Travis love and turn it into something more modern and befitting and old fan.

interview

How'd we get to the people we now are - the two that connected. For me? British pop-rock, rejection, Everquest, and lingering feeling of elevation. What a jerk, eh? Fuck it, that's what I am.

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 14° MOSTLY CLEAR

SATURDAY, AUGUST 3, 2013 AT 8:31 AM

Writing

http://www.reddit.com/r/AskReddit/comments/1jltqn/writers_...
http://www.reddit.com/r/AskReddit/comments/1jltqn/writers_of_reddit_what_are_exceptionally_simple/cbfyn4u

Really interesting writing advice from Chuck Palahniuk. Don't use thought-verbs: wonder, think, remember, believe, etc. Instead, unpack it. Also, love and hate - don't use them. Present characters to readers through action and let the reader feel as though they are forming an understanding of the character's inner workings.

http://www.reddit.com/r/AskReddit/comments/1jltqn/writers_...
http://www.reddit.com/r/AskReddit/comments/1jltqn/writers_of_reddit_what_are_exceptionally_simple/cbg1zxy

Another from Gary Provost. Vary sentence length.

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 14° SHOWERS

TUESDAY, AUGUST 6, 2013 AT 10:53 PM

5 days past due

Well... we should have known this day could come. This evening, after a moderate breakdown, we went for a little car ride. We looked at the house we could have ended up purchasing on Filatre ave. It's still for sale! I picked up some beer and B picked up some veggie chips and we enjoyed an evening of Jeopardy and Planet Earth.

Any day now. Looking forward to my alone time being redefined - baby and me! Can't wait. What a sap I've become.

Tomorrow to do:

- finish **The Little Prince**
- help clean the house

CANADA •

FRIDAY, AUGUST 9, 2013 AT 1:34 PM



8 days past due

In the hospital at is moment getting a second stress test done. Not much else to report. We are both incredibly impatient, but it'll all be worth it soon enough.

Hmm... What else? Got a load of wood dropped off this morning. I'm going to have to learn how to chop it up. One more duty to check off on the 'becoming a man' checklist.

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MONDAY, AUGUST 12, 2013 AT 12:41 PM



Induction Day - Part I

It is now 12:40pm. We've been at the hospital for about four and a half hours now. I picked up some turkey bacon sandwiches from Tim's, which we just ate. Going to be quite the day(s).

Rebecca was given the first dose of gel at 9:45 and since then the tightenings have gotten slightly more noticeable.. Now her leg feels funny. Now it doesn't.

So far the only constant has been back pain. Could be something - could just be back pain.

Dr. Healy did a quick ultrasound before applying the gel. The head measured 9.8cm. A fine size for a head.

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MONDAY, AUGUST 12, 2013 AT 3:16 PM



Induction Day - Part II

She's been having back pain for the past couple of hours. We think something might be happening, but it's hard to say for sure. We'll see the OB shortly. Right now she is hooked back up to the monitor and the contraction/tightenings seem to be close together. It would be strange for it to happen this quickly... !!

The second dose of gel was not a pleasant experience.

5:42 - the first (and only) curse. 'Fuck'

Water breaks at about 6:10. Nerves shoot through roof. (Hers)

7:20 - She's getting Demerol to calm her shakes.

...

...

Around 8, she begs me to get her a nurse because she needs to push (the nurse from the previous shift had only moments before told her to do this).

The team assembles and she begins to push.

9:03 - baby is born. I'm in awe of her strength. He's beautiful.

I keep closing my eyes and opening them to look at him anew.

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TUESDAY, AUGUST 13, 2013 AT 12:30 PM



Mom and Son

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WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 14, 2013 AT 7:47 PM

We are home

I'm tired. I should be napping now. Rebecca is in on the bed with little Theodore now. He just had a great big successful feed.

CANADA •

SATURDAY, AUGUST 17, 2013 AT 8:45 PM



This ain't easy

Theodore is now 5 days old. With some help from the in-laws, we got our best sleep last night... and I still feel exhausted. The kid can cry. He's perfectly happy to just feed for comfort during these difficult bouts, which tells me there is nothing wrong (other than the fact that he's days old).

I often forget, and Rebecca has expressed this as well, that this is forever. This is now what life is. A character building time of life. These few days home from the hospital have already altered me.

The crying bouts can be extremely stressful. I can see why there is such stress placed in baby pamphlets and books to NEVER SHAKE the baby. Even getting the slightest bit mad is counterproductive - but being in the control of your emotions when you're exhausted at 5 in the morning, on no sleep, with a baby screaming in your face is incredibly difficult. I'm not saying that i

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WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 21, 2013 AT 10:20 PM

Listen

- to Hank Williams
- to my being behind the thoughts
- to my wife
- to my son
- to the birds
- to the present moment

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 20° MOSTLY CLOUDY

SATURDAY, AUGUST 24, 2013 AT 11:13 PM

Time

Time is a strange thing these days. Most of the day is of course devoted to Theodore. Between diaper changes and keeping Rebecca company while she feeds the little guy I'm getting in some quality **War and Peace** time. I'm going to finish it this time. I'm looking forward to watching the marathon length Soviet movie production afterwards...

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 11° MOSTLY CLEAR

TUESDAY, AUGUST 27, 2013 AT 6:52 AM

Anniversary

Morning:

Married two years today. It's been a very full two years and a great time in my life. Theodore, finishing my CS degree, running, house-buying, and putting out my last cigarette are a few of the wonderful things that have happened in that span.

Evening:

Ride ride ride. Loving the newest Dylan bootleg album.

We got out to Harbour Grounds for a quick lunch today. Our first outing without Theodore. It was nice of Lisa to hold the reins for the hour we were away.

I applied for another Grenfell job today. The HR department is going to become familiar with my name. Soon enough they'll give me a job just to shut up me up. I can see myself in that environment. There will be a learning curve and a lot of growing pains in whichever respectable job I end up in, but it will be so worth it. I can't wait to have that growing over and done with... I've been putting it off longer than perhaps anyone.

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 14° SHOWERS

THURSDAY, AUGUST 29, 2013 AT 10:44 PM

Week Three

Marginalia: making notes in the margin of a book you are reading. Do it. Mark those suckers up.

Use my moleskine book as a quote/passage book.

Baby Theodore is still being a baby. Two massive poops today. During the first he peed all over himself. Belly, face, hair, wall. All over. On the second his leg was covered in poop. We still love him very much.

CANADA •

SATURDAY, AUGUST 31, 2013 AT 12:28 AM

Thirsty Boots

Write about how I'm feeling right now. That feeling of semi-drunken, poetically driven meaning. Write it and sing like it. Find a voice that's already there.

To clarify - that feeling is one of hopeless abandon. My good thoughts and intentions will be forfeit come morning. Sigh sigh sigh.

Religion: remember that I was there - I tried to believe. I gave it a shot but it just didn't stick and it really didn't have a chance. It's important to remember though that I did try. I may yet see myself there again though I doubt it at it at this moment.

Rebecca is the fiercest warrior I've ever come across. I'm incredibly lucky to be bound to such a spirit. I'm a guileless lamb at the worst of times and a willing participant at the best of them. She makes me better. Now her and Theodore together are, without knowing, pulling at my very depths. I'm searching vigorously for what I can, should, will, want to be.

About the newest dylan album:

He sings songs as if looking down upon us all, proclaiming with a knowing grin. That he does this with others' songs is really quite something.

MASSEY DRIVE, NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR, CANADA • 12° CLOUDY

September 2013

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 20, 2013 AT 10:20 AM



A September Entry

Well, I've finally found some time to put fingers to keys. That's not completely true - I should be pinning clothes on the line at this moment and/or (ok, **and**) fixing up my resume and sending it to my mother for some chance at playing the "who you know" game to get a job. Seems like one of the necessary ramps to jump.

Theodore celebrated his first month of life in St. John's. We had a

lovely visit, filled with family and friends. I got the chance to make a quick visit to Value Village. Like everything else, those visits have changed. No longer do I linger over all the book shelves because I know my time with the books I already possess will quick and greedy (at least for the near future).

Life is all about choosing from a pile of things that need to be done. Reading, running, watching television, and writing are in another pile of things that I could do instead of things that need to be done. I don't get there often and when I do there is sometimes a guilt behind it. To be fair though, Rebecca has been extremely gracious in giving me time to do at least one of those things in any given day.

Anyhow, this has been a great moment to get back to collecting some thoughts.

CANADA •

October 2013

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 13, 2013 AT 12:28 AM



St Anthony

We arrived in town by moonlight last night. This morning, I was struck by how peaceful and rural the town looked from the high vantage point of Lisa's house. We walked Fishing Point Trail in the morning and came across a black fox. I believe he is a particularly dark silver-tipped fox. Theodore slept through the entire walk and ended it with cold, rosy cheeks.

This afternoon we went to L'anse aux Meadows. The highlight was reaching the top of a hill and listening to the roar of the ocean to the north, west, and east of me and Theodore.

CANADA •

December 2013

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 4, 2013 AT 10:21 PM



So, I haven't put any thoughts to paper in quite sometime. Here I goes.

Theodore is now eight days shy of 4 months.

This week we've started changing his sleep schedule - he now sleeps in his crib, which has been moved to our bedroom. We've had two nights of the bed to ourselves. Strangely, that's going to take a bit of getting used to. I've been dreaming some pretty strange dreams these past two nights and I have a feeling it's due to the brokenness of sleep. I'm waking up each and every time he stirs it seems; which is not a lot, but enough to mess up my sleep.

Anyhooo, nice to have the bed back!

Mom and dad will be making the trip from St. John's this Friday to spend the weekend in town with us. Theodore's stranger-danger ways will be tested for the second weekend in a row (Lisa, Steven, Aiden, and the other grandparents visited).

Massey Drive has seen a rare early December respite from the snows. No more. I heard the plot just this moment, looked out the window, and already saw myself powering the snowblower early

tomorrow morning.

Things I'm currently at:

Learning Android development

Relearning some guitar fundamentals with justinguitar.com

Studying for the real estate exam (crazy)

Playing iOS boardgames (LoW + Carc)

Created in Day One